ARCHITECTS

The Grange, Bank Lane,

Roehampton, London SW15 5JT

Project No: 26/393

DESIGN AND ACCESS STATEMENT

Prior Approval: Change of Use from Offices (Class E) to Residential (Class C3) Class MA, Part 3, Schedule 2, Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (as amended).



1. Introduction

1.1 This Planning and Design & Access Statement has been prepared in support of a prior approval application submitted on behalf of The Governor and Company of the Bank of England for the change of use of The Grange from offices (Class E) to residential use (Class C3).

1.2 The application is made pursuant to Class MA of Part 3, Schedule 2 of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (as amended) ("the GPDO").

1.3 The proposal comprises the conversion of the existing building to provide 48 self-contained residential flats, arranged across the ground to fourth floors. The proposal is wholly contained within the existing building and no external alterations are proposed.

1.4 Although a conventional Design and Access Statement is not a statutory requirement for an application of this nature, this document has been prepared to assist the consideration of the proposal. In particular, it explains how the existing commercial building has been sensitively and efficiently adapted for residential use and demonstrates the considered approach taken to layout, access, servicing and residential quality.

1.5 The proposal represents the effective reuse of an existing building, retaining its established structure, envelope, circulation cores and external appearance while introducing a high-quality residential use within the existing built form.

1.6 This statement should be read alongside the other documents submitted in support of the application, including:

- ME Architects drawings and Accommodation Schedule;
- Daylight and Sunlight Amenity Report prepared by Consil Limited; and
- Transport and servicing information prepared by RGP Transport Consultants, including swept-path analysis for refuse and fire service vehicles.
- Flooding and Drainage Report prepared by RGP.
- Acoustic Assessment prepared by Murray Acoustics.
- Contamination Assessment (Geo-environmental Desktop Study) prepared by Manhire Associates.
- Planning Statement prepared by Knight Frank.

The proposed scheme design has also been prepared in consultation with BB7 Fire Consultants to ensure the proposals comply with all relevant fire safety standards. Given the building is not classified as a high-risk building, a Fire Statement has not been provided as part of this submission.

2. Site and Context



2.1 Location

The Grange is situated off Bank Lane, Roehampton, within the wider former Bank of England Sports Ground complex in the London Borough of Wandsworth.

The site benefits from a distinctive open and landscaped setting. The surrounding sports grounds provide substantial separation between The Grange and much of the surrounding development, resulting in a relatively spacious and secluded character despite the site's London location.

2.2 Building Appearance

The Grange is a substantial, formally composed building with a strong classical architectural character, expressed through its symmetrical proportions, regular bay spacing and disciplined vertical and horizontal hierarchy. The elevations are predominantly constructed in red brick, with contrasting stone dressings, including pronounced quoins, window surrounds, string courses and lintel detailing, which give the façades depth and definition. The windows are arranged in a highly regular pattern, reinforcing the building's sense of order and uniformity.

The principal elevation is centred on a more decorative entrance composition, with a projecting central bay, stone-framed entrance, pedimented detailing and a prominent clock tower, giving the building a clear focal point. At roof level, the centre of the building is finished with a mansard-style roof, incorporating regularly spaced dormer windows behind a low

parapet line. Overall, the building has a strong presence, with its scale, symmetry and restrained classical detailing giving it a formal and well-balanced appearance.

2.3 The Existing Building

The Grange is an existing five-storey office building comprising ground to fourth floors (with basement services) and currently falling within Class E use.

The existing building is served by three separate vertical circulation cores, each incorporating a lift and staircase.

The building is also served by an existing car park, which is to be retained and partially adopted as part of the proposed residential use.

The application proposes no alteration to the existing footprint, height, elevations, roof form or fenestration of The Grange. Its established external appearance and relationship with the wider site will therefore remain unchanged.



2.4 Surrounding Context

The Grange forms part of the wider former Bank of England Sports Ground complex. Wandsworth Council's planning records identify The Grange itself as SW15 5JT, while the adjoining wider sports ground is commonly referenced as SW15 5JQ.

The building has historically formed part of the Bank of England estate and has accommodated office, leisure and ancillary uses, with the wider complex historically functioning as a sports and recreation facility.

The site has a distinctly green and spacious character when compared with the more densely developed residential areas of Roehampton beyond. The Grange sits within a substantial landscaped recreational setting incorporating grass playing fields, tennis facilities, access roads and associated buildings.

Mature trees, hedgerows and other established planting are important features of the wider site. These contribute positively to its landscape character and provide a substantial degree of visual separation between The Grange, the surrounding sporting facilities and neighbouring residential development.

2.5 Residential Context and Opportunity

The nearest residential properties are principally located along Bank Lane, Roehampton Gate and Roedean Crescent. Previous consultation records associated with development at The Grange also identify Pembroke House on Roedean Crescent and Record Cottages within the wider sports-ground estate as neighbouring properties.

The surrounding residential context is generally characterised by sizeable detached and semi-detached properties along Bank Lane, Roehampton Gate and Roedean Crescent, many set within mature landscaped gardens.

The separation provided by the sports grounds, internal access routes and established vegetation gives The Grange a comparatively secluded setting and distinguishes it from the more closely developed residential streets surrounding the wider site.

Against this context, the reuse of the existing office building for residential purposes provides an opportunity to introduce new homes through the effective adaptation of existing built fabric, without increasing the footprint, height or external massing of the building.

2.6 Planning Context

Class MA of the GPDO permits the change of use of qualifying buildings falling within commercial, business and service use to dwellinghouses, subject to the relevant limitations, conditions and consideration of the prescribed prior approval matters.

The application has therefore been developed specifically as a change-of-use proposal within the existing building.

No external alterations form part of the application. The architectural response is consequently focused upon achieving an appropriate residential layout within the established building envelope, together with suitable arrangements for access, circulation, parking, cycle storage, refuse storage and servicing.

3. The Proposal

3.1 The proposal seeks the conversion of The Grange to provide 48 self-contained residential units arranged across five floors, from ground to fourth-floor level.

3.2 The existing building footprint, height, elevations, roof and fenestration will remain unchanged. The conversion therefore makes use of the existing built form without introducing additional massing or external development.

3.3 The internal design has been informed by a series of clear principles:

- reuse of the existing building, structure and three circulation cores;
- provision of a balanced residential unit mix informed by Knight Frank's market advice;
- development of apartment layouts around the existing structural grid and window arrangement;
- provision of internal accommodation designed to meet the relevant London Plan Policy D6 space standards as well as Nationally Described Space Standards.
- retention a repurposing of the existing car park, including accessible, electric vehicle and standard parking spaces;
- provision of secure internal cycle storage; and
- provision of internal waste storage in a location accessible to residents without the need to leave the building.

3.4 The proposal has sought to work positively with the constraints and opportunities presented by the existing commercial building rather than impose a residential arrangement that would require significant physical alteration.

3.5 Sustainability and Building Reuse

A principal benefit of the proposal is the retention and reuse of the existing building.

Retaining the established structure and external envelope preserves the embodied carbon already invested in the building and avoids the significant waste, material consumption and construction activity that would be associated with demolition and redevelopment.

The proposed conversion therefore provides a resource-efficient means of bringing the existing building into productive residential use while retaining its established relationship with the surrounding landscape.

4. Use and Amount

4.1 Accommodation

The development will provide a total of 48 self-contained residential flats. The detailed unit mix is set out within the submitted Accommodation Schedule and has been informed by advice from Knight Frank's marketing team to reflect market demand in the area.

The accommodation provides a broad range of home sizes, with the overall mix weighted towards one- and two-bedroom flats while also providing 7 three-bedroom family-sized homes as well as 5 studios.

The range of dwelling sizes provides accommodation capable of meeting differing household requirements while making efficient use of the existing building and its established structural and fenestration pattern.

The proposed accommodation has a maximum occupancy of 157 residents.

5. Layout and Residential Design

5.1 Design Approach

The internal layouts have been developed in direct response to the existing building.

As the proposal retains the established height, footprint, elevations and window openings, the design process has focused on achieving an efficient and high-quality arrangement of residential accommodation within those existing parameters.

The design team has therefore worked with the existing structural grid, established window positions, three circulation cores and existing floor-to-floor heights.

This approach allows the building to be converted with a minimum of unnecessary intervention while ensuring that its existing physical characteristics are used positively in the organisation of the proposed homes.



5.2 Making Effective Use of the Existing Building

Flat boundaries have been arranged with regard to the existing structural grid and circulation cores. This provides a logical basis for the subdivision of the floorplates, limits the need for significant structural intervention and contributes to the practical deliverability of the conversion.

The proposed apartments have been arranged to make effective use of the building's existing window openings. Residential accommodation has been positioned so that the established fenestration serves the principal habitable rooms wherever possible.

The arrangement of apartments responds to the building's existing orientation and benefits from the comparatively open setting provided by the surrounding sports grounds and landscaped areas.

The absence of closely adjoining development around much of the building provides a generally open outlook and allows the existing window arrangement to be used effectively in creating residential accommodation.

5.3 Habitable and Ancillary Spaces

Principal habitable accommodation, including living, kitchen and dining areas and bedrooms, has been located within the parts of the floorplate benefiting directly from the existing windows.

Ancillary accommodation, including bathrooms and storage areas, is located within the more internal parts of the floorplate where appropriate. This enables the available external wall and window positions to be prioritised for rooms in which daylight, outlook and residential amenity are of greatest importance.

The resulting arrangement represents an efficient response to the established commercial floorplate while seeking to provide practical and comfortable residential accommodation.

The quality of daylight and sunlight available to the proposed accommodation is considered in detail within the separate Daylight and Sunlight Amenity Report prepared by Consil Limited, which accompanies the application.

6. Access, Circulation and Servicing

6.1 Site Access

Bank Lane provides the existing vehicular and pedestrian access to the wider site from Priory Lane.

Bank Lane falls from Priory Lane towards the sports ground, with The Grange occupying a comparatively low-lying position within the wider recreational landscape. Within the sports complex itself, the surrounding land is generally open and relatively level, consistent with its longstanding sporting and recreational use.

6.2 Building Access

The existing West facing Main access into The Grange will be retained as part of the proposed conversion. The building also benefits from existing access on the East facing (rear) elevation into the rear communal areas and core.

The Waste and Cycle stores also benefit from existing rear facing entrances.

As no external alterations are proposed, the established relationship between the entrances, surrounding access routes and existing car-parking areas will remain materially unchanged.

6.3 Internal Circulation

The existing building benefits from three separate circulation cores.

Each core incorporates a staircase and lift serving the building from ground to fourth-floor level. These existing cores have been retained and incorporated into the residential layout.

At ground-floor level, the three cores are linked internally, providing connectivity across the building.

Retaining the established circulation infrastructure represents an efficient use of the existing building and has been an important organising principle in the development of the proposed apartment layouts.

6.4 Parking, Cycles, Refuse and Servicing

The existing car park will be partially adopted to serve The Grange following its conversion to residential use, with 36 car parking (including 4 accessible) spaces assigned for use by residents of The Grange. The proposed parking provision includes accessible, electric vehicle and standard parking spaces, as detailed within the submitted drawings and supporting transport information.

Secure cycle storage is provided internally within the building with 64 cycle parking spaces located at ground-floor level on the eastern side of the development, adjacent to the bin store.

Refuse storage is also accommodated internally and has been arranged so that residents are able to access the facility without leaving the building.

The transport, access and servicing arrangements are considered further within accompanying Transport Statement and Travel Plan prepared by RGP transport consultants, including swept-path analysis relating to refuse collection and fire service vehicle access.

7. Summary

7.1 The proposal provides for the effective reuse of The Grange through its conversion from Class E office accommodation to 48 self-contained Class C3 residential flats pursuant to Class MA of the GPDO.

7.2 The scheme has been deliberately developed around the characteristics of the existing building. Its footprint, height, elevations, roof form and fenestration will all remain

unchanged, with the proposed works focused upon the internal adaptation necessary to provide residential accommodation.

7.3 The proposed layouts make considered use of the building's existing structural grid, window arrangement and three established circulation cores. Habitable accommodation has been positioned to benefit from the existing windows and outlook, with ancillary spaces accommodated within the more internal parts of the floorplate where appropriate.

7.4 The development provides a broad mix of homes, including 7 three-bedroom family-sized dwellings, within a total provision of 48 residential units and a maximum occupancy of 157 residents. A detailed accommodation schedule forms part of the Prior Approval application submission.

7.5 Existing vehicular and pedestrian access arrangements will be retained. The development also incorporates 36 car parking (including 4 accessible) spaces, 64 secure cycle parking spaces and internal refuse provision, with servicing and vehicle access considered within the accompanying transport information.

7.6 The conversion also makes efficient use of an existing building. By retaining the established structure and envelope, the proposal preserves embodied carbon and avoids the additional material consumption, waste and disruption associated with demolition and redevelopment.

7.7 Overall, the proposal represents a considered and efficient conversion of an existing commercial building to residential use. It provides new homes within the established building envelope, retains the external appearance and landscape relationship of The Grange, and responds positively to the opportunities and constraints presented by the existing building.

7.8 The submitted drawings and supporting technical information demonstrate the detailed operation and quality of the proposed residential conversion and should be read alongside this statement in the consideration of the application for prior approval.

8. Conclusion

Given the detailed and considered approach to the proposed conversion, it is considered that the development will make a positive contribution to the local housing stock, while providing a respectful and sympathetic change of use that makes effective use of the existing building and retains its established character and relationship with the surrounding context.